

FASHION DESIGN AND MERCHANDISING

Administered by the Department of Apparel, Events, and Hospitality Management. Leading to the degree Bachelor of Science.

Total credits required: 123 including a minimum of 18 credits in FDM at Iowa State University for the degree (12 of the 18 credits must be at the 3000-4000 level). The major in Fashion Design and Merchandising provides a broad-based program of study with flexibility in creating program options. Courses are required in general education and the apparel industry professional core. To complete the program, a student selects a primary option from Creative and Technical Design, Product Development and Innovation, Merchandising and Retail Analytics, or Fashion Communications.

Available options include two minors— (a) Fashion Design and Merchandising, and (b) Textile Science and Product Performance—and one certificate in Merchandising.

Student Learning Outcomes

Upon graduation, students should be able to:

1. *Communication.* Use clear and effective written, oral, verbal and electronic (WOVE) communication techniques to foster inquiry, collaboration, and engagement in apparel and related industries.
2. *Self-assessment/self-reflection.* Analyze and evaluate one's own knowledge, abilities, and actions relative to professional standards, seek opportunities to grow professionally, and utilize self-assessment and assessment of others to foster psychological, cognitive, social and emotional well-being.
3. *Critical thinking.* Understand fundamental concepts of apparel, merchandising, and design and apply critical thinking to solve problems from personal, scholarly, and professional perspectives.
4. *Ethics, Diversity, and Social Responsibility.* Demonstrate leadership and social justice to improve quality of life for global citizens and encourage socially responsible decision-making for consumers and businesses.

UNDERGRADUATE STUDY

The program offers study for the degree of Bachelor of Science with a major in Fashion Design and Merchandising (FDM). The program offers students a broad understanding of textile and apparel products, merchandising and marketing strategies, technical and creative design, product development, production processes, and business practices leading to a wide range of careers at state, national, and international levels in business and industry. Courses in the program provide scientific, technical, and humanistic knowledge about textiles, apparel, and related products basic to career preparation. Courses also provide knowledge

applicable to the development and use of apparel and textile products by individuals, families, and institutions. The program provides a foundation for graduate study. Graduates understand the production, distribution, and use of textiles and apparel, aesthetic expression, and communication. They are prepared to plan, develop, source and present textile and apparel products to meet the needs of consumers. Students understand the issues involved in textile and apparel production and marketing, both nationally and internationally.

The FDM major provides a broad-based program of study with flexibility in creating an individualized program. To complete the program, a student combines general education, FDM core classes, and a structure of focused courses to form an option in: (a) creative and technical design, (b) fashion communication, (c) product development and innovation, or (d) merchandising and retail analytics.

An option in *creative and technical design* is appropriate for those interested in the aesthetic and creative aspects of design, technical design, costuming, textile design, and product development. The *fashion communications* option prepares students for the development and delivery of visual, written, and oral communication. Career opportunities are in visual merchandising, styling, fashion influencing, social media, and communication. An option in *product development and innovation* is appropriate for those interested in developing innovative products for special markets including accessories, footwear, performance wear, smart textiles, functional apparel, and soft goods for home. Career opportunities include designer, materials testing, quality assurance, and technical design. An option in *merchandising and retail analytics* prepares students for the planning, promotion, and presentation of market-oriented product lines and events. Career opportunities are in buying, promotion, sales, product development, branding, and management in both manufacturing and retailing sectors with a focus on the textile and apparel industry.

For additional courses of interest, see Fashion Design and Merchandising.

GRADE POINT REQUIREMENT

All students majoring in Fashion Design and Merchandising are required to earn a C- or better in all AESHM and FDM courses applied toward the degree, including transfer credits.

COMMUNICATION PROFICIENCY REQUIREMENT

Undergraduate English proficiency is certified when the student has received a grade of C or better in ENGL 1500 Critical Thinking and Communication, and ENGL 2500 Written, Oral, Visual, and Electronic Composition.

Curriculum in FASHION DESIGN AND Merchandising

Administered by the Department of Apparel, Events, and Hospitality Management (AESHM). Leading to the degree bachelor of science.

Total credits required: 123, including a minimum of 18 credits in FDM at Iowa State University for the degree (12 of the 18 credits must be at the 3000-4000 level). Leads to the degree Bachelor of Science. Administered by the AESHM Department. All students majoring in Fashion, Design, and Merchandising (FDM) are required to earn a C- or better in all FDM, AESHM, EVENT, and HSPM courses applied toward the degree, including transfer credits. All students majoring in Fashion, Design, and Merchandising (FDM) are required to earn a C or better in ENGL 1500 and ENGL 2500. No courses may be applied to more than one degree requirement except those used to meet U.S. Cultures and Communities and International Perspectives requirements.

Cr. Degree Requirements

(10) COMMUNICATIONS AND LIBRARY

ENGL 1500	Critical Thinking and Communication	3
ENGL 2500	Written, Oral, Visual, and Electronic Composition	3
LIB 1600	Introduction to College Level Research	1
Select one (1) course from:		3
COMST 2100	Communication and U.S. Diversity	
COMST 2140	Professional Communication	
COMST 2180	Communication and Conflict Management	
SPCM 2120	Fundamentals of Public Speaking	
Total Credits		10

(9-12) NATURAL SCIENCE AND MATH

Select one (1) class from:		3
MATH 1040	Introduction to Probability	
MATH 1050	Introduction to Mathematical Ideas	
MATH 1400	College Algebra	
MATH 1430	Preparation for Calculus	
MATH 1500	Discrete Mathematics for Business and Social Sciences	
MATH 1510	Calculus for Business and Social Sciences	
Merchandising & Retailing Analytics: Recommended MATH 1500		
Creative and Tech Design, Product Development, and Product Management Options must take:		3-5
CHEM 1630	College Chemistry	
CHEM 1630L	Laboratory in College Chemistry	
Merchandising & Retail Analytics and Fashion Communications Options select one (1) course from:		

Department of ASTRO, BIOL, CHEM, ENVS, GEN, GEOL, MTEOR, PHYS, or FSHN (101 OR 167)

Select one (1) class from:		3-4
STAT 1010	Principles of Statistics	
STAT 1040	Introduction to Statistics	
STAT 2026	Introduction to Business Statistics	
Total Credits		9-12

(15) HUMANITIES AND SOCIAL SCIENCES

ECON 1010	Principles of Microeconomics	3
FDM 1650	Fashion and Society: An Introduction	3
FDM 3560	Fashion History II: Mid-19th Century to the Present	3
Select one (1) class from:		3
ARTH or HIST Departments		
Creative & Tech Deigns must take ART H		
Select one (1) course from: Humanities & Social Sciences list or one of the following courses:		3
FDM 3540	Fashion History I: Prehistoric to Mid-19th Century	
FDM 3620	Global Fashion	
Total Credits		15

ALL FDM STUDENTS COMPLETE:

(12-15) AESHM PROFESSIONAL DEVELOPMENT

AESHM 1110	Professional Development for AESHM	1
AESHM 1110L	AESHM Program Orientation and Learning Community	1
AESHM 2110	Leadership Experiences and Development (LEAD)	3
AESHM 3110N	Seminar on Careers and Internships: Apparel, Merchandising, and Design	1
AESHM 4700MX	Supervised Professional Internship: Apparel (Out-of-state)	3
OR		
AESHM 4700N	Supervised Professional Internship: Apparel	3
AND		
If internship completed in home state, select 3 credits from:		3
AESHM 2800	Orientation to U.S. Field Study	
AESHM 3800N	U.S. Field Study: Apparel, Merchandising, and Design	
AESHM 2810	Orientation to International Field Study	
AESHM 3810N	International Field Study: Apparel, Merchandising, and Design	
AESHM 1700N	Supervised Work Experience I: Apparel	
AESHM 1800N	First Year Student Field Study: Apparel, Merchandising, and Design	

AESHM 2700N	Supervised Work Experience II: Apparel	
AESHM 2870	Principles of Management in Human Sciences	
AESHM 4210	Developing Global Leadership: Maximizing Human Potential	

Total Credits 15

(25) FDM INTEGRATED CORE

FDM 1310	Fashion Products and Markets	3
FDM 2040	Textile Science	4
FDM 2100	Computer Applications in Digital Design	3
FDM 2310	Product Development and Manufacturing	3
FDM 2450	Aesthetics and Brand Image	3
FDM 2750	Retail Merchandising	3
FDM 3720	Sourcing and Global Issues	3
COMS 1130	Introduction to Spreadsheets and Databases	3

Total Credits 25

PRIMARY OPTIONS

Select one professional primary option from the following 4 choices:
Creative & Technical Design, Product Development & Innovation, Merchandising & Retail Analytics, and Fashion Communications (minor required)

(43) Creative & Technical Design

FDM 1200	Intro to Apparel Assembly Processes	1
FDM 1210	Apparel Assembly Processes	3
FDM 1780	Introduction to Apparel Design Studio	3
FDM 2250	Patternmaking I: Drafting and Flat Pattern	3
FDM 2780	Fashion Illustration	3
FDM 3100	Computer Aided Apparel Patternmaking	3
FDM 3210	Computer Integrated Textile and Fashion Design	3
FDM 3250	Patternmaking II: Draping	3
FDM 4260	Creative Design Processes	3
FDM 4150	Technical Design Processes	3
FDM 4950	Senior Design Studio	3
Select one (1) course from:		3

FDM 3050	Quality Assurance of Textiles and Apparel	
FDM 4040	Innovative Textiles	
FDM 4310	Apparel Production Management	
Select one (1) course from:		3
FDM 3540	Fashion History I: Prehistoric to Mid-19th Century	
FDM 3620	Global Fashion	

Option "electives" (work with your advisor) 6

Total Credits 43

(43) Product Development & INNOVATION

FDM 1200	Intro to Apparel Assembly Processes	1
FDM 1210	Apparel Assembly Processes	3
FDM 1780	Introduction to Apparel Design Studio	3
FDM 2250	Patternmaking I: Drafting and Flat Pattern	3
FDM 3050	Quality Assurance of Textiles and Apparel	3
FDM 3100	Computer Aided Apparel Patternmaking	3
FDM 3210	Computer Integrated Textile and Fashion Design	3
FDM 4040	Innovative Textiles	3
FDM 4150	Technical Design Processes	3
FDM 4310	Apparel Production Management	3
FDM 4960	Soft-Goods Product Development and Prototyping	3
SCM 3010	Supply Chain Management	3

(9) Option electives. Select from FDM, AESHM, THTRE, ART, DSGN, DSNS or SCM 9

Total Credits 43

(43) Merchandising & Retail Analytics

ACCT 2840	Financial Accounting	3
AESHM 3400	Hospitality and Apparel Marketing Strategies	3
or MKT 3400	Principles of Marketing	
AESHM 4740	Entrepreneurship in Human Sciences	3
FDM 3750	Omni-Channel Retailing and Retail Technologies	3
FDM 3760	Merchandise Planning and Buying	3
FDM 3760L	Merchandising Planning and Buying Lab	1
FDM 3770	Visual Presentation and Promotions	3
FDM 3880	Trend Forecasting	3
FDM 4670	Consumer Studies in Apparel and Fashion Products	3
FDM 4750	Retail Analytics	3
DS 2010	Introduction to Data Science	3
Option "electives" (work with your advisor)		12

Total Credits 43

(36-37) Fashion Communication

ACCT 2840	Financial Accounting	3
or AESHM 1750N	Financial Applications for Retail and Hospitality Industries: Retail Merchandising	
AESHM 3400	Hospitality and Apparel Marketing Strategies	3
or MKT 3400	Principles of Marketing	
AESHM 4740	Entrepreneurship in Human Sciences	3
FDM 2880	Styling	3
FDM 3760	Merchandise Planning and Buying	3
FDM 3760L	Merchandising Planning and Buying Lab	1

FDM 3770	Visual Presentation and Promotions	3
FDM 3880	Trend Forecasting	3
EVENT 1710	Introduction to Event Management	3
EVENT 2770	Digital Promotion in the Service Industry	3
Option "electives" (work with your advisor)		9
A minor is required for this option, so talk with your advisor for more information.		
Total Credits		37

Fashion Design and Merchandising B.S. - Creative and Technical Design
Primary Option

Freshman

Fall	Credits	Spring	Credits
ENGL 1500		3 ENGL 2500	3
FDM 1310		3 MATH 1400	3
FDM 1650		3 FDM 1210	3
FDM 1780		3 FDM 2040	4
AESHM 1110		1 FDM 2060	Required
AESHM 1110L		1 FDM 2450	3
LIB 1600		1	
15		16	

Sophomore

Fall	Credits	Spring	Credits
FDM 2100		3 FDM 2250	3
FDM 2750		3 AESHM 2110	3
FDM 2780		3 ARTH 2810	3
Humanities & Social Science Choice		3 COMS 1130	3
CHEM 1630		4 ECON 1010	3
CHEM 1630L		1	
17		15	

Junior

Fall	Credits	Spring	Credits	Summer	Credits
FDM 2310		3 FDM 3100		3 AESHM 4700N	5
FDM 3210		3 FDM 3290		3	
FDM 3250		3 FDM 3560		3	
AESHM 3110N		1 AESHM 2800		R	
STAT 1010		4 AESHM 3800N		3	
		Speech Choice		3	
14		15		5	

Senior

Fall	Credits	Spring	Credits
FDM 3720		3 Creative & Technical Design Option Elective 2	3
FDM 4150		3 FDM 4310	3
FDM 4950		3 FDM 3620	3
Creative & Technical Design Option Elective 1		3 Elective	3
12		12	

Total Credits: 121

Fashion Design and Merchandising B.S - Merchandising & Retail
Analytics Primary Option

Freshman

Fall	Credits	Spring	Credits
ENGL 1500		3 ENGL 2500	3
FDM 1310		3 FDM 2450	3
FDM 1650		3 FDM 2040	4
AESHM 1110		1 COMS 1130	3
AESHM 1110L		1 ECON 1010	3
LIB 1600		1	
MATH 1400		3	
15		16	

Sophomore

Fall	Credits	Spring	Credits
FDM 2750		3 FDM 3560	3
FDM 2100		3 FDM 3760	3
Option Elective		3 FDM 3760L	1
ACCT 2840		3 AESHM 2110	3
History/ ARTH		3 DS 2010	3
		AESHM 3400	3
15		16	

Junior

Fall	Credits	Spring	Credits	Summer	Credits
FDM 2310		3 FDM 3750		3 AESHM 4700N	3
FDM 3770		3 FDM 4750		3	

Option	3 FDM 3880	3
Elective		
AESHM 3110N	1 STAT 1010	4
Science	3 Merchandising	3
Choice	Option	
	Elective 3	
	13	16

Senior

Fall	Credits	Spring	Credits
FDM 3720	3 AESHM 4740	3	
FDM 4670	3 Option	3	
	Elective		
Humanities	3 COMSTSpeech	3	
or Social	Choice		
Science			
Elective			
Elective	3 Merchandising	3	
	Elective 3		
Elective	3 Elective	2	
	15	14	

Total Credits: 123

Fashion Design and Merchandising B.S. - Product Development & Innovation Primary Option

Freshman

Fall	Credits	Spring	Credits
ENGL 1500	3 ENGL 2500	3	
FDM 1310	3 FDM 1200	1	
FDM 1650	3 FDM 1210	3	
FDM 1780	3 CHEM 1630	4	
AESHM 1110	1 CHEM 1630L	1	
AESHM 1110L	1 MATH 1400	3	
LIB 1600	1		
FDM 1200	1		
	16	15	

Sophomore

Fall	Credits	Spring	Credits
FDM 2250	3 ECON 1010	3	
FDM 2040	4 COMS 1130	3	
Humanities/	3 AESHM 2110	3	
Social			
science			
FDM 2750	3 AESHM 3110N	1	

FDM 2100	3 FDM 2450	3
	16	13

Junior

Fall	Credits	Spring	Credits	Summer	Credits
STAT 1010		4 FDM 3210		3 AESHM 4700N	3
FDM 3760		3 FDM 3560 ^{Spring}		3	
FDM 3760L		1 FDM 3100		3	
FDM 3720		3 FDM 4040 ^{Spring}		3	
FDM 2310		3 History or		3	
		Art History			
		Choice			
Elective		1			
	15		15		3

Senior

Fall	Credits	Spring	Credits
FDM 3050		3 FDM 4310	3
COMST/		3 FDM 4960	3
Speech			
Choice			
FDM 4150		3 Product	3
		Development	
		and	
		Innovation	
		Elective 3	
SCM 3010		3 Elective	3
Option		3 Elective	3
Elective			
	15	15	

Total Credits: 123

Fashion Design and Merchandising B.S. -- Fashion Communications Primary Option

Freshman

Fall	Credits	Spring	Credits
ENGL 1500		3 ENGL 2500	3
FDM 1310		3 FDM 2100	3
FDM 1650		3 FDM 2450	3
AESHM 1110		1 EVENT 1710	3
AESHM 1110L		1 MATH	3
LIB 1600		1	
Humanities/		3	
Social			
Science			
	15	15	

Sophomore

Fall	Credits	Spring	Credits
FDM 2040		4 AESHM 1750N	2
FDM 2750		3 FDM 3760	3
STAT 1040		3 FDM 3760L	1
COMS 1130		3 AESHM 2110	3
		ECON 1010	3
		EVENT 2770	3
13		15	

Junior

Fall	Credits	Spring	Credits	Summer	Credits
FDM 2310		3 FDM 3560		3 AESHM 4700N	3
FDM 2880		3 FDM 3770		3	
Option		3 FDM 3880		3	
Elective					
AESHM 3110N		1 Option		3	
		Elective			
AESHM 3400		3 Minor		3	
MKT 3400					
Elective		2			
15		15		3	

Senior

Fall	Credits	Spring	Credits
FDM 3720		3 AESHM 4740	3
COMST/ SPEECHh Choice		3 History or ART	3
Minor		3 Minor	3
Class 3		Class 5	
Minor		3 Option	3
Class 4		Elective	
Science		3 Minor	3
15		15	

Total Credits: 121

Fashion Design and Merchandising

A minor in Fashion Design and Merchandising requires (15-17 cr.) of the following:

FDM 1310	Fashion Products and Markets	3
FDM 2040	Textile Science	4
FDM 2310	Product Development and Manufacturing	3
FDM 2750	Retail Merchandising	3
FDM 3720	Sourcing and Global Issues	3

Select 3 credits from: 3

FDM 3540	Fashion History I: Prehistoric to Mid-19th Century
FDM 3560	Fashion History II: Mid-19th Century to the Present
FDM 3620	Global Fashion
FDM 3750	Omni-Channel Retailing and Retail Technologies
FDM 3760	Merchandise Planning and Buying
FDM 3770	Visual Presentation and Promotions
FDM 3880	Trend Forecasting
AESHM 4740	Entrepreneurship in Human Sciences

Total Credits 19

TEXTILE SCIENCE AND PRODUCT PERFORMANCE MINOR

The Textile Science and Product Performance minor is targeted specifically at the scientific, innovative, evaluative, technological, and performative aspects of textiles, and will fulfill industry demands for graduates that can provide answers to complex, interdisciplinary issues linked to textile-centered products. Textiles are utilized daily in: (a) medical procedures, (b) shelters and homes, (c) transportation, (d) physical and psychological protection, (e) physical performance, (f) adornment.

The minor is designed for:

- Students in the STEM fields of chemistry, chemical and biological engineering, and materials science and engineering who desire academic experiences and knowledge in another applied product area.
- Students in the apparel, merchandising, and design, areas who want a focused concentration on textile science and the evaluation of quality and performance of textiles and textile products.

Learning Outcomes

Students who complete the Textile Science and Product Performance minor will meet the following over-arching learning objectives:

- Apply a comprehensive understanding of the characteristics (physical, chemical and structural) of textiles/textile products and the interrelationship of these characteristics to their major discipline.
- Engage in interdisciplinary research through the analysis, testing and evaluation of textiles and textile products for sustainable industry and global applications in their major.

Requirements

The Textile Science and Product Performance minor consists of 17 credits, including 14 credits distributed over four required classes. Six of

the nine required 3000-4000 level credits in the minor must be taken at Iowa State University. Nine credits must be isolated to the minor only.

FDM 2040	Textile Science	4
FDM 2310	Product Development and Manufacturing	3
FDM 3050	Quality Assurance of Textiles and Apparel	3
FDM 4040	Innovative Textiles	3

Select one for 3 credits from:

AESHM 4700N	Supervised Professional Internship: Apparel
FDM 4900A	Independent Study: Textile Science
FDM 4990	Undergraduate Research

Merchandising Certificate

A certificate in Merchandising requires (22 cr.) of the following:

FDM 2750	Retail Merchandising	3
FDM 3750	Omni-Channel Retailing and Retail Technologies	3
FDM 3760	Merchandise Planning and Buying	3
FDM 3760L	Merchandising Planning and Buying Lab	1
FDM 4750	Retail Analytics	3
Select from:		9

AESHM 2870	Principles of Management in Human Sciences
AESHM 3400	Hospitality and Apparel Marketing Strategies
AESHM 3420	Aesthetics of Consumer Experience
AESHM 4700N	Supervised Professional Internship: Apparel
AESHM 4740	Entrepreneurship in Human Sciences
FDM 1650	Fashion and Society: An Introduction
FDM 2450	Aesthetics and Brand Image
FDM 3720	Sourcing and Global Issues
FDM 3770	Visual Presentation and Promotions
FDM 4670	Consumer Studies in Apparel and Fashion Products

Total Credits **22**

The Merchandising Certificate may be earned at the same time as an ISU baccalaureate degree or after the completion of an associate of arts (AA) or associate of science (AS) degree or a baccalaureate degree from any accredited institution.

The FDM program offers a **concurrent B.S. and M.S. degree** that allows students to obtain a B.S. and M.S. degree in Fashion Design and Merchandising in **five** years. Application for admission to the Graduate College should be made in the junior year. More information can be found here: <https://aeshm.hs.iastate.edu/graduate-students/graduate-programs/apparel-merchandising-and-design/concurrent-bs-ms/>.

Graduate Study

The program offers work for the concurrent Bachelor of Science and Master of Science; Master of Science (thesis and non-thesis options; on-campus and hybrid); and Doctor of Philosophy (on-campus and distance hybrid) with a major in apparel, merchandising, and design. For all programs the field of study is highly interdisciplinary; programs of study are tailored to students' background and interests. The program offers a concurrent B.S. and M.S. degree that allows students to obtain both the B.S. and M.S. degrees in apparel, merchandising, and design in 5 years. Application for admission to the Graduate College should be submitted in fall semester of the junior year.

Graduates understand how textiles and apparel are essential in meeting individual and societal needs and understand the interdependence of nations and cultures as producers and consumers. Graduates understand diverse philosophies of scholarship and apply multiple methods to creative activity, research, and teaching. Strong writing and oral communication skills help graduates disseminate scholarship and compete successfully for awards and grants.

Graduates accept positions relevant to their academic experience. All doctoral graduates have teaching experience. Master's and doctoral graduates have experience working in team-oriented and interactive environments. Graduates are prepared to adapt to future changes in their professions and to provide leadership in professional and public practice. They bring a strong sense of ethics to research, teaching, and business endeavors.

Program emphases for graduate study include creative design and functional design; product development; consumer behavior; entrepreneurship; merchandising and marketing aspects of textiles and clothing; acquisition and use of textiles and apparel within cultures; U.S. dress and textiles from the 19th into the 21st centuries; textiles and sustainability.